



Windows 95 introduced a UI paradigm that has been used by all versions of Windows since, with some deviations in Windows 8 / 8.1

DOS-based ones for home users, and the NT-based ones for servers and workstations into a single NT-based OS family – something they wanted to do since NT was first introduced.

Then came another OS that most people would like to forget, but one that lay a lot of important groundwork for what Windows is today, and that is Windows Vista. Internally Windows Vista and Windows Server 2008 featured Windows NT 6.0 and this is somewhat significant for reasons that will become clear soon.

When Windows 7 came out, the name made sense given that Microsoft wanted to go back to version numbers, and that the previous version was internally Windows NT 6.0. However Windows 7 wasn't very different at its core, and was mostly compatible with Vista. Since the kernel was mostly the same internally, Windows 7 only updated the Windows version to NT 6.1. So when Microsoft finally updated its branding to reflect the version of Windows beneath it, well the version of Windows beneath it no longer followed the same numbering scheme! Windows 8 bumped this version to 6.2 and then Windows 8.1 brought this up to 6.3.

Windows 7 is the most popular version of Windows ever released, but it was basically Windows Vista.1

Now we come to Windows 10, and you probably feel

Quick on the heels of Windows ME came Windows XP, that despite its age and obsolescence still runs on a significant number of computers. Internally Windows XP was based on Windows 2000 and was versioned as Windows NT 5.1.

At this point the old lineage of DOS-based Windows versions was over as Windows XP merged Microsoft's two lines of products, the



Windows XP was the first consumer version of Windows to use the Windows NT kernel.